

IT Systems Landscape



In this activity, you will explore **Phase 01** of the Cyber Security Operations Process Cycle : **IT Systems Landscape**.

Learning Objectives

- Understand the **Context (C)** in which security operations occur
- Map your project to real-world IT domains
- Identify integration points and dependencies
- Build shared technical vocabulary

Part 1: Landscape Exploration (15 minutes)

Scenario: You're joining an organisation as a Security Operations team member.

The organisation has:

- 8 international offices in 6 different time zones
- 3,000 employees globally
- Complex, distributed IT infrastructure

Below is their IT Systems Landscape. Your task is to understand where your project fits within this environment:

Infrastructure & Network

- Global WAN infrastructure connecting all 8 offices
- Multi-region cloud infrastructure (e.g., AWS, Azure, or GCP) with geo-redundancy
- Regional data centres with edge computing capabilities
- Software-defined networking (SDN) for optimal routing
- Global load balancers and CDN services

Communication & Collaboration

- Unified communications platform supporting voice, video, and chat
- Global email system with regional servers
- Document management and collaboration tools
- Intranet portal with multi-language support
- Virtual meeting rooms and conferencing systems

Security & Compliance

- Identity and access management (IAM) system
- Multi-factor authentication
- Security information and event management (SIEM)
- Data loss prevention (DLP)
- Regional compliance monitoring tools
- Global security operations centre (SOC)
- Incident response and case management platforms
- Threat intelligence sharing
- Vulnerability management systems
- Security automation and orchestration

Data Management

- Distributed database systems
- Data warehousing solution
- Log aggregation and analysis platforms
- Business intelligence platforms
- Data backup and recovery systems
- Data governance and compliance tools
- Real-time data streaming

Development & Operations

- Distributed version control systems
- CI/CD pipelines with regional build servers
- Container orchestration platforms
- Configuration management and automation tools
- Microservices architecture
- API gateway and service mesh
- Global monitoring and alerting system

Individual Task:

- 1. Identify your project's primary domain(s)**
 - a. Where does your project operate in this landscape?
 - b. Mark 2-3 specific systems/technologies your project would interact with
- 2. Find integration points**
 - a. What data does your project need FROM other systems?
 - b. What data/alerts does your project provide TO other systems?
- 3. Identify 2 unfamiliar concepts** you need to research

Part 2: Glossary Contribution (10 minutes)

Add your 2 researched concepts to the [shared glossary](#) using this template:

Term: [Name] **Definition:** [Your own words] **Relevance:** [Why it matters to your project]
Context: [Where it sits in the landscape] **Source:** [Link] **Added by:** [Name]

Why This activity?**For your project:**

- Helps define clear task boundaries
- Identifies technical concepts to research
- Shows where your work fits in real-world operations

For your assessment:

- Help you understand the **Context (C)** for your STAR narratives
- Demonstrates industry awareness
- Helps you articulate the real-world relevance of your work

For your career:

- Security operations don't happen in isolation
- Understanding the bigger picture makes you more valuable
- Employers want people who see connections, not just their own piece